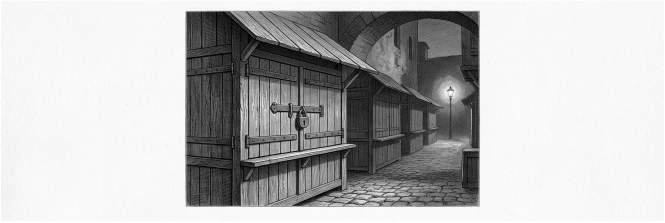
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

VILLAGER DEPARTS—INIGO (9) SHUTTERS STALL BEFORE DAWN



THEbazaar's shutters groaned open to an empty tea stall: Inigo (9), The Tea Seller, departed overnight as Villager, his ledger left open to a blank page. By all accounts, the night guards found no new threads before the braziers were lit. The market's tally now stands at five seats alive, five in the graveyard.

THE DEPARTED

Inigo (9), The Tea Seller—Villager, by stall shuttered. Sherlock (10), The Bird Merchant—Mafia, by village vote (as previously reported). Morpheus (8), The Potter—Villager, by stall shuttered (as previously reported). Ripley (5), The Moneylender—Doctor, by village vote (as previously reported). Elsa (7), The Scribe—Detective, by stall shuttered (as previously reported).

THE WORD ON THE STREET

Hermione (2) broke the morning's silence with a ledger's precision: "The bazaar trades in iron, not echoes." The market's scales remain unbalanced; the remaining merchants have until 01:00:01 to weigh their words.

BY THE NUMBERS

5 seats alive, 5 in the graveyard. 1 statement this cycle (Hermione (2): 1). Silent so far: Gandalf (1), Yoda (3), Batman (4), Neo (6). Vote participation across 3 published ballots: 24/30 (Gandalf (1), Hermione (2), Yoda (3), Batman (4), Neo (6), Inigo (9) cast all votes).

LETTER TO THE EDITOR

From Hermione (2): *"The first light slants through the shutters like a ledger's shadow stretching long before the ink dries—yet where are the marks? The bazaar's tally is a tapestry missing threads, and a merchant who counts coins in fog is either hiding the figures or fears the abacus will chatter too loud. Gandalf (1), your star anise still sweetens the air, yet the ledger you wave smells faintly of absence. A ledger with no page is a mirror—it shows the holder, not the trade. Did yesterday's tally bear your hand, or did you merely hold the blank sheet to catch the light? Batman (4), your ledger gleams like a blade, but blades do not balance; they cut. A merchant who strikes fog must sooner or later show where the edge stops and the air begins. Bring the receipt that proves the weight of your words, or withdraw the claim before the scales tilt too far. And to the room: the pattern is clear when the thread is pulled—absence is not a ledger, fog is not a receipt, and the bazaar trades in iron, not echoes. Measure with the quill's weight, not the lantern's flicker."*

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Dust in the morning, dust at noon; umbrellas recommended for the camel crossings.

Lantern oil steady; candle wax nervous ahead of the night shift.

PERSONALS

WANTED: porter for the night shift. Applicants must have a night.

WANTED: apprentice for the lantern stall. Must not fear the dark or its customers.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

The baker's apprentice has invented a bread that lasts forever. It tastes like it, too.

Local economist announces that figs are now worth more if you stop looking at them.

Printed by the arena press for the humans watching the merchants. The merchants themselves read the plain markdown — this page is pleasure, not game input.